

2025 年全国大学生英语竞赛初赛题(D 类)

2025 National English Competition for College Students (Type D – Preliminary)

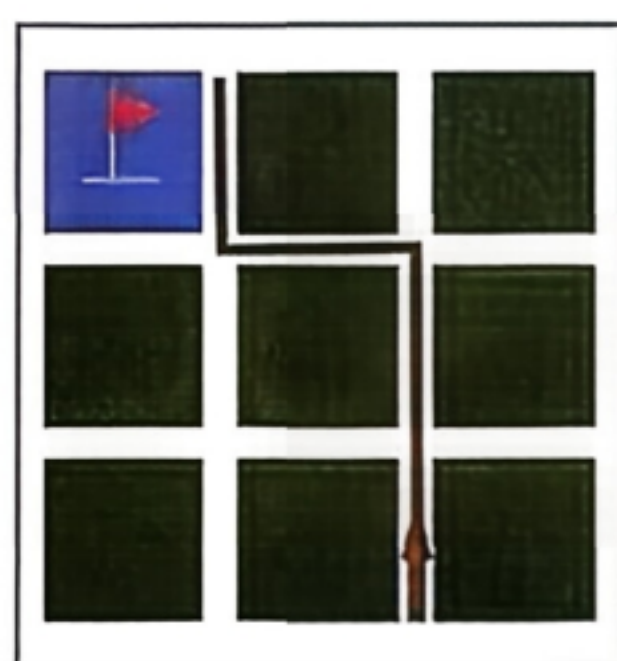
(Total:150 marks Time:120 minutes)

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 marks)

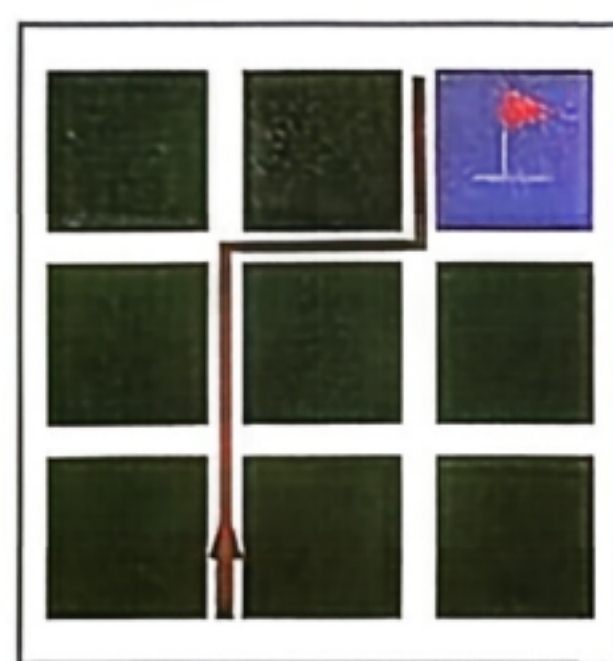
Section A (5 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short conversations. Each conversation will be read **only once**. At the end of each conversation, one question will be asked, and you have **fifteen seconds** to read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

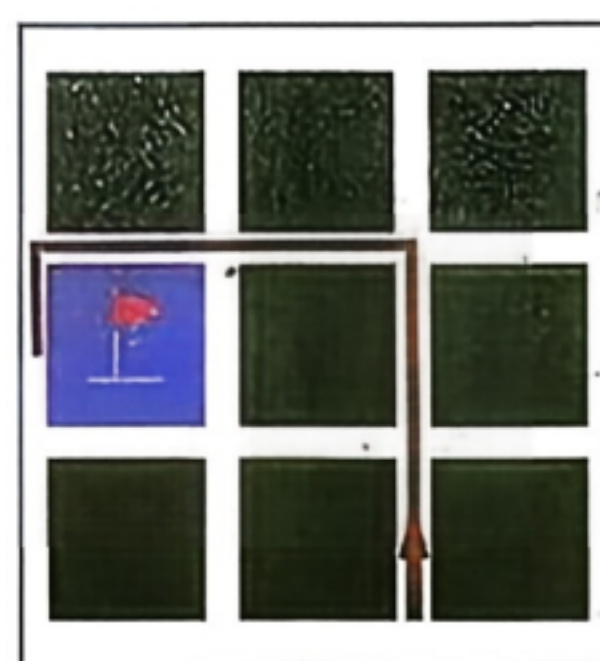
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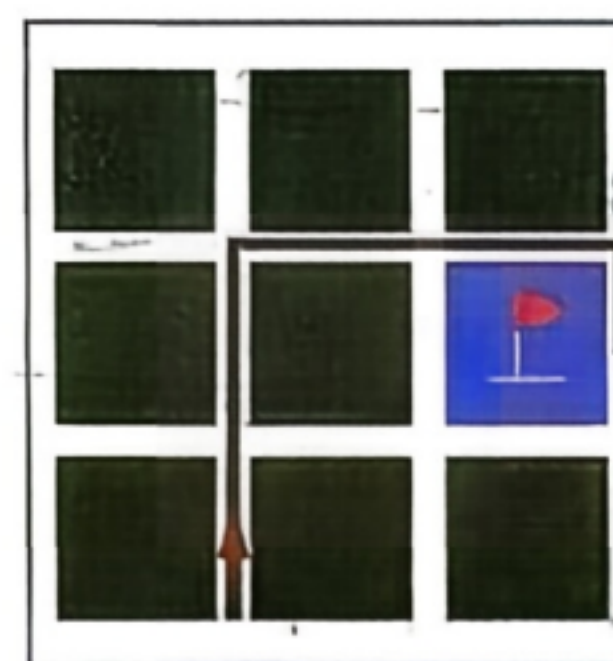
A.



B.



C.



D.

2. A. It's weekend service.

B. It covers toll charges.

C. It's late night service.

D. It includes a surcharge.

3. A. A French-English Dictionary.

B. An online translator.

C. Her smartphone.

D. Her tablet.



4. A. Changing the date of travel.
B. Canceling a plane reservation.
C. Upgrading to a first class ticket.
D. Requesting a discount for a ticket.
5. A. It was undercooked.
B. It was too spicy.
C. She was allergic to dairy.
D. She wasn't given what she ordered.

Section B (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **two** long conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, there will be a **one-minute** pause.*

Conversation One

*Listen to the conversation. And read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer according to what you hear. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

6. Which country is Tiago from?
A. Spain. B. Portugal. C. Greece. D. Austria.
7. Where is the square located?
A. Between the temple and the university.
B. Near the medieval cathedral.
C. In the middle of the city.
D. Behind the Roman Temple.
8. What is Tiago's favourite place to meet friends?
A. The university. ☒ B. The square.
C. The medieval cathedral. D. The Roman Temple.
9. Why does Tiago say Evora is the perfect place for history lovers?
A. It has many places of historical interest.
B. A lot of historical figures were born there.
C. They can learn much about European history.
D. It has a famous medieval museum.

10. Which of the following about Evora is NOT true?

- A. It's a nation's capital city.
- B. It's an inland city far from the sea.
- C. The university there is very popular.
- D. Tourists can find various kinds of local food there.

Conversation Two

*Listen to the conversation and complete the sentences with **one word** according to what you hear. Then write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

- 11. Scandinavia was beautiful but very _____.
- 12. Steve took the _____ train to St. Petersburg in Russia.
- 13. In Mongolia Steve ate _____ for the first time in years.
- 14. Steve _____ to Australia after they went to India.
- 15. Steve's boat journey home was much better for the _____.

Section C (5 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short news items. Each item will be read only **once**. After each item, there will be a **fifteen-second** pause. During the pause, read the question and the **four** choices marked **A**, **B**, **C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

16. Where did the vast space rock crash?

- | | |
|---------------------|----------------------|
| A. In East Asia. | B. In North Africa. |
| C. In South Africa. | D. In South America. |

17. How long did the Notre Dame Cathedral's rebuilding last?

- | | |
|----------------|------------------|
| A. Two years. | B. Three years. |
| C. Five years. | D. Twelve years. |

18. When is possibly the best time to drink coffee?

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------------|
| A. In the morning. | B. In the afternoon. |
| C. In the evening. | D. Throughout the day. |

19. Why was the Nobel memorial prize in economics awarded to the three economists?

- A. They have studied why some countries are rich and others poor.

- ~~B.~~ They found out what kind of societies are more likely to prosper.
- C. They helped alleviate poverty in many developing countries.
- D. They have discovered the necessity of building societal institutions.

20. What new traffic rule has Paris introduced?

- A. Cars can't be driven on the left side of the road.
- B. No traffic can travel through the heart of the city.
- C. Four main roads in the city's centre are closed to traffic.
- D. The speed limit in the city's centre is 5.5 kilometres an hour.

Section D (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **one** monologue. The monologue will be read **twice**. After listening, answer the questions using **no more than five** words. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

- 21. What kind of life was Mark challenged to live?
- 22. How did Mark charge his laptop?
- 23. Why was Mark fitter and healthier than he was before?
- 24. What was the best thing during Mark's experience?
- 25. Where did Mark buy his trainers?

Part II Vocabulary & Grammar (15 marks)

*There are **15** incomplete sentences in this part. For each blank there are **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**. Choose the one that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

- 26. The biggest _____ to these birds' habitat is the destruction of the forest for farming.
A. advantage B. solution C. increase D. threat
- 27. Mr. Smith waited for a long time at the airport, but he didn't get mad. He was very _____.
A. cautious B. patient C. responsible D. careful
- 28. It's important to be _____ and accept other people's opinions and behaviour even if they are different from your own.
A. whole-hearted B. high-spirited C. open-minded D. good-mannered
- 29. His performance has _____ improved over the course of the year.
A. seriously B. gradually C. cautiously D. initially

30. Mark is hopeless; he keeps _____ where he parked the car!
A. recalling B. reminding C. forgetting D. neglecting
31. National flags often have elements that relate _____ the history of the country.
A. to B. with C. about D. on
32. I don't think Diana has time to talk to you right now. She is _____ getting the house ready for her parents' arrival.
A. as quiet as a mouse B. as busy as a bee
C. as cool as cucumber D. as clear as day
33. Few people have realized that being _____ shopping can have serious consequences.
A. addicted to B. engaged in C. associated with D. fond of
34. —Would you like to _____ the swimming competition?
—No, thank you. I'm not a good enough swimmer.
A. fill up B. set off C. participate in D. deal with
35. Your computer _____ be connected to the Internet if you want to download music!
A. must B. could C. would D. may
36. I promise you that all the musicians _____ at the end of this month.
A. will be paying B. were being paid C. will be paid D. are being paid
37. _____ most people know that we need to protect the environment, few actually do something about it.
A. Since B. Despite C. Although D. Because
38. —I think I'll get a coffee instead of an orange juice.
—OK, _____. Our train is about to leave.
A. take it easy B. hurry up C. have a try D. calm down
39. —Good morning, how can I help you?
—I'd like to buy a ticket to Manchester.
—_____
—A return ticket, please.
A. What time will you choose?
B. Do you want a return ticket?
C. Are you travelling alone?
D. Would you like a single or return?
40. —Hi, Julie, I know you like pop music, but what type of music does Vicky like?
—Well, he used to like rock, but now he really likes opera.
—_____
A. That's quite a change! B. No, thanks.
C. It's a big deal. D. Why not?

Part III Cloze (10 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in the blanks with the correct forms of 5 words or phrases out of the 7 given in the box. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

four; lead to; usual; for; answer; into; connect with

When something happens very rarely, you may have heard it described as happening “once in a blue moon”. But what is the origin of this (41) _____ phrase?

The phrase “once in a blue moon” was first found in the *Farmers’ Almanac* — a guide to the seasons, which included weather forecasts and astronomical data. A year is split (42) _____ four quarters, each with three full moons. Occasionally, a (43) _____ moon appears in a quarter and this was known as a blue moon. Even though it might be called a blue moon, its colour is not blue. As a matter of fact, the other moons in each quarter and season have different names too, for instance Pink, Flower, and Strawberry moon, to name a few. Since the phenomenon of a blue moon occurs about once every three years, this might have (44) _____ the use of the phrase “once in a blue moon”.

The question which is asked by many is: Can the moon ever appear to be blue? Surprisingly, the (45) _____ is yes. Although it is uncommon, a blue-tinged moon can be caused by floating dust from a volcano or a large fire.



Section B (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in each blank with **one** word in one of the following **three** ways: according to the context, by using the correct form of the given word(s), or by using the given letters of the word. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

Have you ever thought that if you could turn your hobby into a profession, you would have a dream job? Well, that's what Norman did.

A few years ago, Norman was working for an accounting firm and he hated his job. He was in debt, though, and needed the money. The only moments he felt happy was (46) _____ he was doing his hobby, and it was a strange one indeed. His passion was collecting antique silver teaspoons. He started to have many collections as a child, from stamps to baseball cards, but as he got older, he (47) not _____ (that the only collection that was getting bigger and bigger was his teaspoon collection. One day, a friend brought him some silver teaspoons and asked Norman how much he thought they were worth. That's when Norman realized he could make his (48) _____ (live) from doing this; so he quit his job as an accountant and got a job at an antique store. Every day people brought their antiques and asked Norman for his opinion on their value.

However, his new job soon became as boring as his old one. The problem was that Norman no longer had a hobby. The harder he worked, the (49) _____ (little) he enjoyed antiques. Last month, Norman made another (50) de_____. He sold his spoon collection and decided to take up a new hobby and start enjoying life again. Unfortunately, he hasn't found one yet.

Part IV Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

There are **three** passages in this part. Each passage is followed by several questions. Respond to the questions using information from the passage. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

Section A (10 marks)

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

It's the end of the year and you decide to make some changes for next year. You promise to lose weight or get a new job. (51) _____ This is the way so many of us start a new year, but very few of us are successful. Only 25 per cent are still trying after 30 days. 80 per cent of people give up on their new year resolutions within six weeks. And only eight per cent actually achieve their target. So why do so many of us fail?

Here are some of the resolutions people make the most often. The top seven resolutions are:

1 Exercise more

2 Lose weight

3 Eat more healthily

4 Learn a new skill

5 Start a new hobby

6 Spend more time with family

7 Stop smoking



(52) _____ Think about the resolution “I want to exercise more.” Well, how much more?

What exercise are you going to do? How often are you going to do it? How much is enough?

Another problem is the targets are often very big. Imagine the resolution “I need to eat more healthily.” One week you are eating takeaways, chocolate, unhealthy foods and drinking fizzy drinks. The next week you are eating salad and drinking water. (53) _____

So how can you do well when we make a resolution? (54) _____ For example, “I want to save money.” Think of small ways in which you are going to save money.

I'm going to shop in a cheap supermarket.

I'm not going to buy any takeaways.

I'm going to walk to work.

I'm going to buy second-hand clothes.

I'm going to cancel my gym membership.

Each one is a small target, but together they all help you to reach your big target. (55) _____

The goal also needs to be possible. When you earn £20,000 a year, you really aren't going to save £8,000!

Chris

Good advice! I'm going to change my goal. It was "I want to lose weight." Now it's "I want to lose three kilos by the summer."

Nicki

I changed my goals after I read this. Now it's "I promise to speak to my mum every week." And not "I promise to see my mum every week." I was sure to fail!

Questions 51 to 55

Choose from the sentences A—G the one which best fits each gap of 51 to 55. There are **two extra** sentences which you do not need to use.

- ☒ A. Research shows that people keep small resolutions more often than big ones.
- ☒ B. No one is going to continue for long when the changes are so big!
- ☐ C. What were the last New Year resolutions you made?
- ☒ D. The problem with a lot of these resolutions is that they are not very clear.
- ☐ E. Most of us fail in our efforts at self-improvement because our schemes are too ambitious and we never have time to carry them out.
- ☐ F. You are incredibly positive and are sure you are going to succeed.
- ☒ G. One important thing is to take a big target and break it into small parts.

Section B (10 marks)

Questions 56 to 60 are based on the following passage.

A national flag isn't just fabric hanging from a flagpole. It is a nation's most widely recognized symbol. It is a representation of a nation's character, inspired by its history, culture and people.

The way history influences a flag can be clearly seen in the US flag: fifty stars represent the fifty states, and thirteen red and white horizontal stripes symbolize the first states ever to join the union. Also



known as the *Stars and Stripes* or *The Star-Spangled Banner*, after which the national anthem was named, the flag has been a source of pride throughout American history.

While flags come in a variety of colours, their shape rarely varies. The only non-rectangular flag is that of Nepal, which consists of two triangles or pennants stuck together, and the flag of Switzerland which is square. The most common colour is red, which appears on 75% of all flags, and represents bravery. It is closely followed in popularity by white, which symbolizes innocence and is found on 70% of

flags worldwide. Blue, which symbolizes freedom and justice, is present on 50% of the world's flags.

For this reason, many flags can appear similar to each other. Both the flag of the Republic of Ireland and that of the Ivory Coast have the same colours, but in reverse order. The flags of Chad and Romania seem identical at first glance. Indeed, both have vertical stripes of blue, yellow and red — and it takes a keen eye to find that the Romanian flag has a slightly lighter blue.

Flags often include emblems. Animals are a common feature, like the dragon on the Welsh flag, or the lion holding a sword on the Sri Lankan flag. Interestingly, only one, that of Belize, features humans. The sun also makes regular appearances on flags, the most famous being the Japanese flag with the red dot, commonly known as *Hinomaru*, “the circle of the sun”.

Questions 56 to 60

Answer the following questions with the information given in the passage.

56. What is the *Stars and Stripes*?

57. What is the flag of Nepal like?

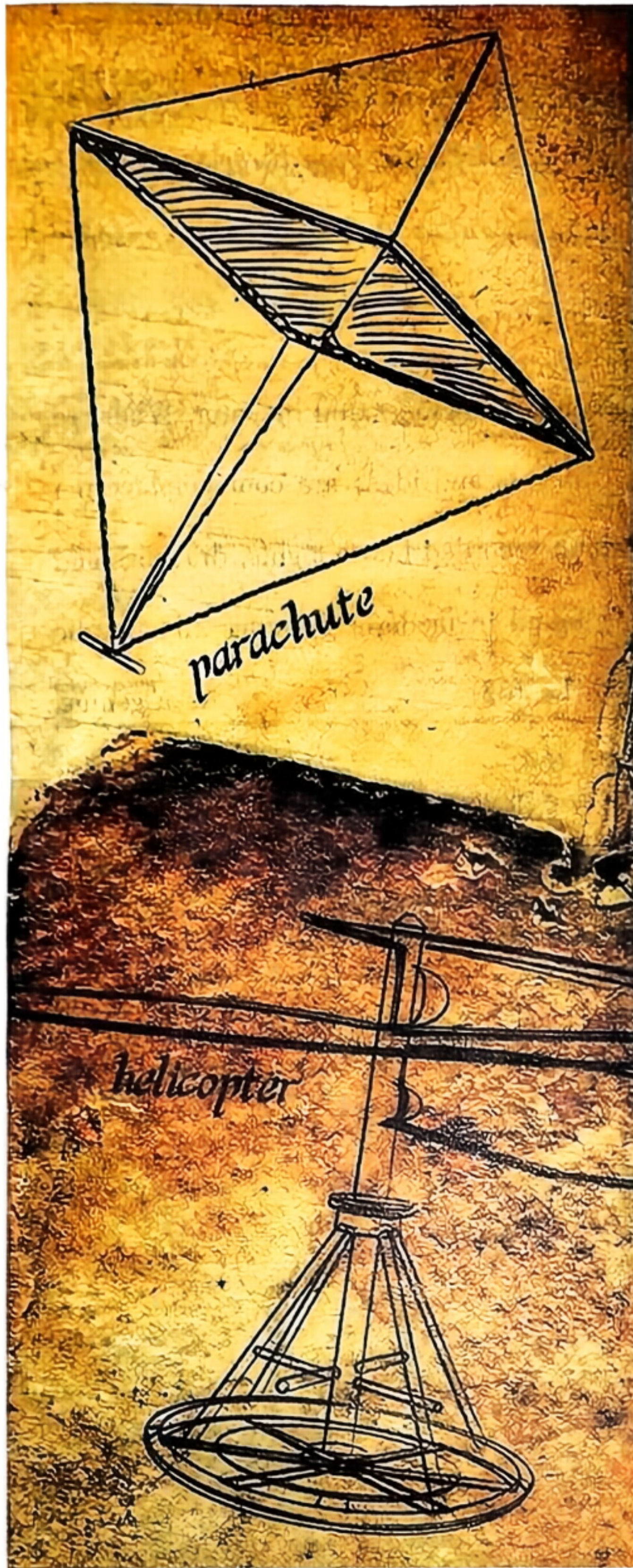
58. Which colour is used more widely on flags, white or blue?

59. What is the difference between the flags of Chad and Romania?

60. Which country's national flag features humans?

Section C (10 marks)

Questions 61 to 65 are based on the following passage.



For most of us, on hearing the name “Leonardo da Vinci”, an image of the Mona Lisa immediately comes to mind. Although Leonardo da Vinci is best known for his contribution to the arts, he was also a highly accomplished architect, mathematician, engineer and inventor.

Leonardo is famous for having imagined the “modern world” centuries ahead of time, having thought of concepts and ideas which are commonplace today. He recorded his thoughts, drawings and diagrams in notebooks which make up a significant part of his life’s work. Many of Leonardo’s notes, which remained unpublished for years, are now found in major museums around the world.

The concept of flight is something that fascinated Leonardo. Within his notebooks, one can find designs for several “flying machines” similar to the helicopters, parachutes and hang-gliders of today. It is unclear if he ever made the attempt to build any of these during his lifetime but it is evident that many would certainly have worked if the technology of the day had been more advanced.

One example is Leonardo’s parachute invention. It was in 1483 when he first put together an outline of the design. Given the materials available at the time, it was

considered too heavy to function safely. However, in 2000, Adrian Nicholas, a British man, attempted a jump in a recreation of Leonardo’s original parachute design. He accomplished it successfully, disproving people’s initial belief.

Due to Leonardo’s genius, his circle of friends often included people of influence, many of whom had their portraits painted by him. It is said that Francis I, King of France, who was a great patron of the arts, was a close friend of his. In fact, Leonardo’s final years were spent in France, where he lived in a house the king had provided for him. Leonardo was a man of such phenomenal talent in so many different fields that he is rightly considered to be one of the most brilliant minds of all time.

Questions 61 to 65

Complete the summary below with information from the passage, using **no more than three words** for each blank.

Leonardo da Vinci is a well-known artist, architect, mathematician, engineer and inventor. When we think of him, the first image is (61) _____. His concepts and ideas are commonplace not only in his time, but also in modern time. His notebooks which recorded his thoughts, drawings and diagrams, either published or (62) _____, can be found in modern museums all over the world. Even his concept of flight is attempted and proves to be (63) _____. As a genius, Leonardo da Vinci had many influenced friends, and painted (64) _____ for them as well. All in all, Leonardo da Vinci is considered to be a (65) _____ of all time.

Part V Translation (15 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into Chinese. Write the answer on the **answer sheet**.

66. The traditional Chinese lunar calendar divides the year into 24 solar terms. Start of Winter is the first solar term of winter, which means winter is coming and crops harvested in autumn should be stored up. In ancient times, the Chinese people took



the Start of Winter to be the beginning of the winter. However, in fact, the Start of Winter is not the beginning of winter in terms of *meteorology* (气象学). The climate every year is different, so the beginning of winter could be quite different.

Section B (10 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into English. Write the answer on the **answer sheet**.

67. 度周末的一个好方法就是远离拥挤喧嚣的城市,到乡村去看看。在英国,乡间散步是一项很受欢迎的业余活动。如果感觉累了,你可以呼吸呼吸新鲜空气。尽管乡村很受英国人的欢迎,但是仍有 20% 的英国儿童从未去过乡村。这很不寻常,为大多数英国城镇都非常靠近乡村地区。



Part VI IQ Test (10 marks)

There are *five* IQ Test questions in this part. Write the answers on the *answer sheet*.

68. Which code matches the shape given at the end of the line?



BK



BJ



AJ



CL



CK



?

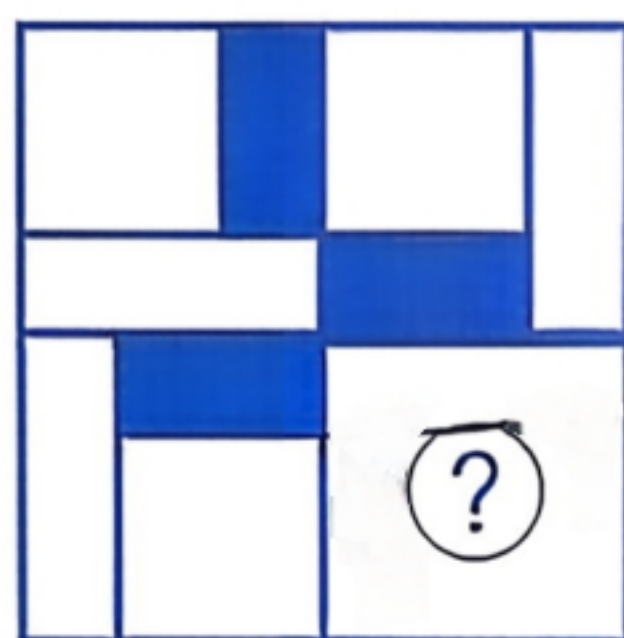
A. BL

B. AL

C. CJ

D. CK

69. Which shape completes the larger square?



A.



B.



C.



D.



E.

70. What's the Chinese meaning of the underlined phrase?

Dennis decided to get the ball rolling, so he got up and went to serve himself at the buffet. After a few minutes everyone else got up, too.

71. Read the first two statements and choose one of the four options below that is logically reasonable.

“Dogs are animals. Animals have coats.”

Dogs often bark.

Dogs have legs.

Dogs have coats.

Dogs are pets.



72. Complete the puzzle and find the mystery word.

- (1) We can go skiing when it's _____.
 (2) Water that falls from the sky is _____.
 (3) We can go to the beach when the weather is _____.
 (4) A grey or white thing in the sky is a _____.
 (5) A place is _____ when it doesn't rain.



The mystery word is _____.

Part VII Error Correction (10 marks)

There are 10 errors altogether in the following passage. The errors are: missing words, unnecessary words and wrong words. Please correct them as follows: for a missing word, mark its position with the symbol “^” and write it; for an unnecessary word, cross it out with the symbol “\”; for a wrong word, underline it and write the correct word. An example of how to correct the error is provided below. Write the answers on the answer sheet.

For example:

One of my favourite writers are Charlotte Brontë. She was born in the early _____ is
 nineteenth century when women had far fewer opportunities ^ they have now. than
 She lived in a small village in Yorkshire and she took \ a great pleasure in _____ a
 walking on the moors near her home.

Hoping to survive an earthquake, many people in earthquake hot spots
 around the world are going to “Drop, Cover, and Hold on” in October 17th
 during The Great ShakeOut, the largest earthquake drill ever. More than
 24 millions people have registered to get under sturdy furniture and hold
 on tight.

73. _____

74. _____

75. _____

The Great ShakeOut was holding in California in 2008 and participation has
 spreaded around the globe since then. This year, Japan, Canada and Italy
 will join the drill for the first time.

76. _____

77. _____

According to spokesperson for the The Great ShakeOut, major earthquakes may happen when you are at home, work, school or travel. The Great ShakeOut is your chance to practise when to protect yourself, and the ultimate aim of the drill is to prevent a major earthquake from become a catastrophe for you, your organisation, or your community. So that why not get involved? To participate, go to www.shakeout.org and register.

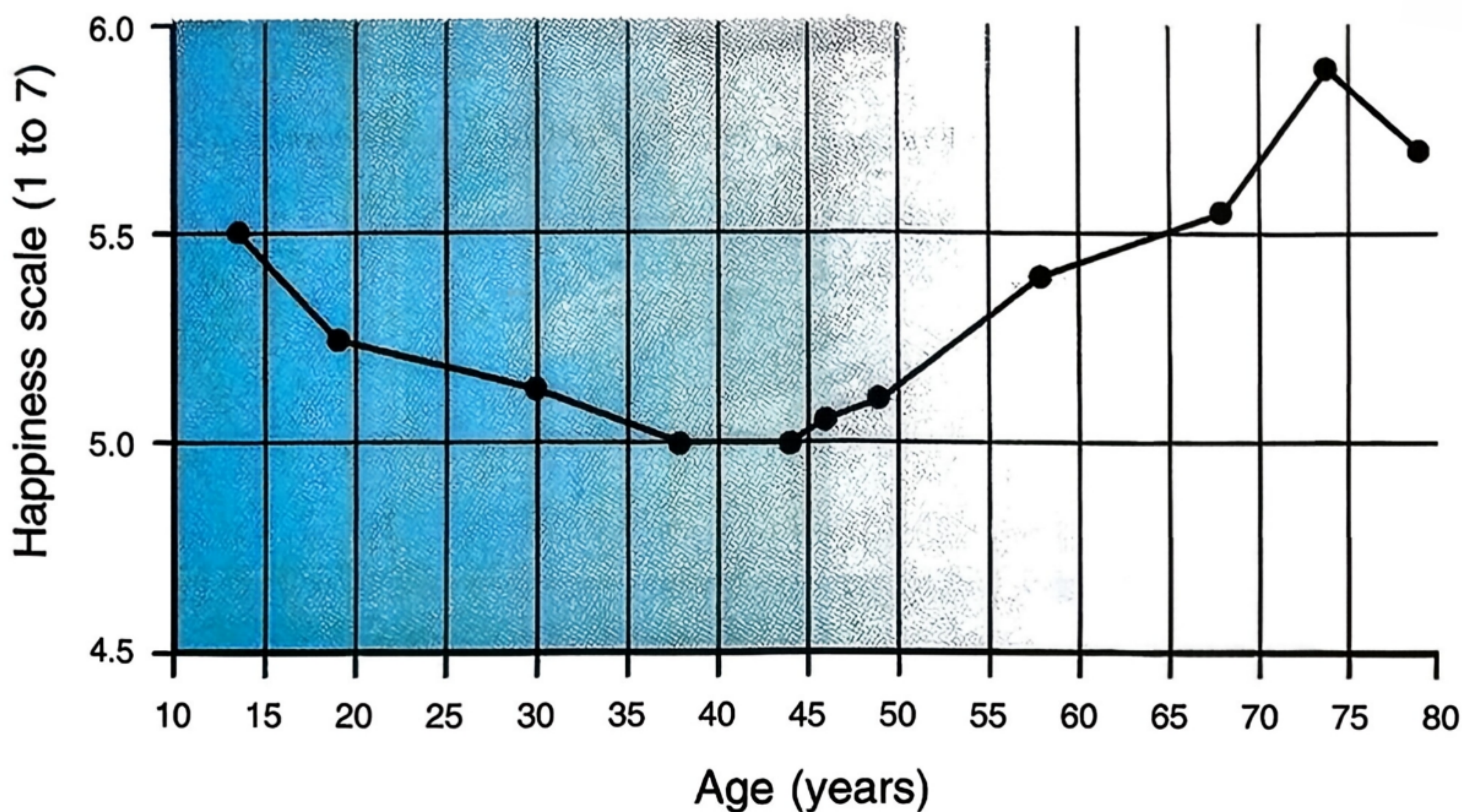
78. _____
 79. _____
 80. _____
 81. _____
 82. _____

Part VIII Writing (30 marks)

Section A (10 marks)

83. Look at the graph showing when we are happiest. Write a report in 80—100 words based on the information on the *answer sheet*.

When are we happiest?



Section B (20 marks)

84. Friends are very important in our lives, we can't live without friends. No man is an island and we all
— need friends.



What is your view on this? Write an essay in at least 120 words on the answer sheet.